

REACTION PAPER ON “Machine Learning: Living in the Age of AI | A WIRED Film”

As a Data Science student, I am already familiar with artificial intelligence and machine learning through my studies and projects. However, watching Machine Learning: Living in the Age of AI made me realize that understanding how AI works is very different from understanding the scale of its consequences. I knew about its capabilities and benefits, but I had not fully considered how deeply it could affect society, employment, privacy, the environment, and our future.

One of the most significant advancements highlighted in the film is the use of AI in healthcare, accessibility, and agriculture. The video showed how machine learning can assist in analyzing medical images and detecting diseases, help people with visual impairments understand their surroundings, and support farmers in making better decisions. These examples showed me that AI is not only about convenience or automation; it can also improve people's quality of life. As a Data Science student, I found this particularly meaningful because it demonstrates how data can be transformed into solutions for real-world problems.

The film also made me think about the Philippines and its growing involvement in advanced technology. In 2026, the Philippines joined Pax Silica, a U.S.-led initiative focused on strengthening supply chains for AI, semiconductors, critical minerals, and other advanced technologies. The planned development of an industrial hub in New Clark City could create opportunities for Filipino students, researchers, engineers, and technology professionals. However, technological development also raises an important question: *at what cost to the environment?*

This is where I see one of the biggest ironies of technological progress. While people are increasingly protesting and calling for action against climate change, pollution, and environmental destruction, humanity continues to develop industries and technologies that require enormous amounts of energy and natural resources. AI is not the sole cause of environmental problems, but its infrastructure also requires significant resources. It is unsettling to think that humans have developed the intelligence to create technologies that can help understand and protect our planet, while the same human activities can also contribute to its destruction.

The video presents AI's future as both promising and uncertain. AI can support healthcare, scientific discoveries, agriculture, and automation, but it also brings challenges such as job displacement, privacy concerns, misinformation, deepfakes, and environmental impact. Therefore, progress should not only be measured by how advanced our technology becomes, but also by how responsibly we use it.

Overall, the film changed my perspective on AI. As a Data Science student, I believe we should not only learn how to build and use AI but also understand its consequences. The future of AI should not simply be about creating smarter machines, it should also be about becoming wiser humans. If we continue advancing technology while neglecting the planet that sustains us, we may eventually create a future where there is no healthy world left to benefit from our innovations.